



CONSTRUCTION CONTINUES at Dodger Stadium as potentially dangerous Santa Ana weather conditions are predicted this week.

ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

Unusually strong winds carry high risk of winter fires, power outages

Southern California officials prepare for ‘life-threatening and destructive’ Santa Anas sweeping over a dry landscape in expected and unexpected areas

By GRACE TOOHEY

By January, Southern California usually has experienced enough rain that a major winter wind event does not bring fears of a major fire. But not this year. After more than eight months without any measurable rainfall, Southland officials are gearing up for

what is expected to be a “life-threatening and destructive” windstorm. The winds will last several days and occur in areas well beyond the region’s typical wind corridors — with the potential to drag the area’s fire season into January. “This upcoming event is extreme,” said Capt. Erik Scott, a spokesperson for the Los Angeles Fire Department. “Many people

think that when the winter months come they might be out of fire danger, and that’s simply not true, especially in Southern California.” Gusty, dry winds — some that could reach up to 100 mph — are forecast across much of Los Angeles and Ventura counties beginning Tuesday and are expected to elevate the threat for fast-moving wildfires and also cause damage to trees,

power lines and even high-profile vehicles. A rare, late-season red flag warning describing “widespread, damaging ... and long-duration” fire weather conditions has been issued for the region through at least Thursday, with a possibility that it could be extended to Friday. This is the first January since 2021 that the National Weather Service’s Los Ange-

les office has issued such an alert. “It’s not a common occurrence,” Rich Thompson, a weather service meteorologist, said of the January red flag warning. But he said it does happen, particularly “at times in our drier winters.” And Southern California is experiencing one of its driest starts in years to what is [See Winds, A10]

Study on fluoride and IQ has its constraints

Relevance of findings to U.S. is not clear and report has critics over its methodology.

By KAREN KAPLAN

A new report linking fluoridated drinking water to lower IQ scores in children is sure to ratchet up the debate over a practice that’s

considered one of the greatest public health achievements of the 20th century. The report published Monday in JAMA Pediatrics synthesizes the results of dozens of research studies that have been released since 1989. Its overall conclusion is that the more fluoride a child is exposed to, the lower he or she tends to score on intelligence tests. The analysis was con-

ducted for the U.S. National Toxicology Program, and it has attracted a good deal of criticism over the many years of its development. Among the biggest critiques is that it’s based on data from places where fluoride levels are far higher than the concentration recommended by the U.S. Public Health Service. Adding fluoride to community drinking water is credited with reducing the

average number of teeth with cavities by 44% in adults and 58% in adolescents since the 1960s, the health service says. Yet even with the proliferation of fluoride-containing toothpastes and dental sealants, tooth decay is still the most common chronic disease affecting American children, and the average senior citizen is missing at least 10 permanent teeth.

About 209 million Americans receive fluoridated water in their taps, according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. Robert F. Kennedy Jr., President-elect Donald Trump’s pick to lead the Department of Health and Human Services, has said he’d like to see that number fall to zero, in part due to concerns over “IQ loss.” The JAMA Pediatrics re- [See Fluoride, A10]

At the Capitol, a very different Jan. 6

Four years after Trump’s supporters stormed the building, Kamala Harris certifies his victory.

By FAITH E. PINHO

WASHINGTON — On a day replete with political symbolism for both parties, Vice President Kamala Harris on Monday officially acknowledged President-elect Donald Trump as the winner of the 2024 election, certifying the electoral college votes. While the certification of votes served as a ceremonial completion to the turbulent 2024 election, the day also marked a momentous anniversary of the violent mob that stormed the Capitol four years ago, when Trump supporters attempted to disrupt the count. Those scarring events were not far from lawmakers’ minds, as many released statements ahead of time commemorating the dark day. But the president-elect was ready to cast a more jubilant tone on his Truth Social page early Monday, calling it “A BIG MOMENT IN HISTORY. MAGA!” While Trump was absent for the ceremony, his one-time opponent from California kept the proceedings civil and businesslike. Harris strode purposefully into the House chamber in a plum-colored suit, leading the senators to the joint session of Congress. She stood stoically at the dais, crossing her hands or passing along manila envelopes with the electoral college vote certificates, as the drone of each state’s official vote count was read — including those from states that voted for her. Ironically, the senators submitted each count to her with the honorific “Madam President,” as Harris served in her capacity as president of the Senate. After just 30 minutes, Harris concluded the tally: “Donald J. Trump from the state of Florida has received 312 votes,” she said, as the House erupted into applause. She smiled widely and, after a moment, hammered her gavel to call the chamber to order. Then, she announced her own results: “Kamala D. Harris from the state of California has received 226 votes.” [See Jan. 6, A5]

Disney agrees to merge Fubo with its Hulu live TV service

New entity will offer a streaming package with ABC and ESPN channels. Deal ends a sports streaming suit.

By STEPHEN BATTAGLIO

Sports streaming service FuboTV Inc. is set to be merged with Walt Disney Co.’s Hulu live TV service, the companies announced Monday, in a deal that clears the way for a joint venture

streaming bundle targeted at sports fans who don’t want to pay for channels they don’t watch. The agreement ends New York-based Fubo’s legal action against Venu Sports, the joint service announced last year by rivals Disney, Fox Corp. and Warner Bros. Discovery. In a suit filed in U.S. district court, Fubo had called the proposed venture “a sports cartel” that violated U.S. antitrust laws. A federal judge agreed and temporarily blocked the service, ruling in August that Venu would “substan-

tially lessen competition and restrain trade.” Fubo said in a statement that Disney will control 70% of the new combined company, which will trade publicly under Fubo’s current stock symbol. Fubo’s existing management team, led by co-founder and Chief Executive David Gandler, will run the new company. The deal is subject to approval by regulators and Fubo shareholders. “We are thrilled to collaborate with Disney to create a consumer-first stream- [See FuboTV, A7]

Newsom touts a small surplus

In a preview of his state budget proposal, the governor says he plans to pull from rainy day reserves. CALIFORNIA, B1

Hollywood gets into a party spirit

Host Nikki Glaser delivers a good time as the Golden Globes usher in the 2025 awards season. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Weather
Breezy in the p.m.
L.A. Basin: 72/55. B6

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TRUDEAU RESIGNS

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